

Winter 2026
COURSE SYLLABUS - MATH 4B

INSTRUCTOR Professor Xu Yang
Office Hours (in person): Tuesday and Thursday 10:50 – 11:50 am
Email: xuyang@math.ucsb.edu

PREREQUISITES Math 4A or Math 4AI with a minimum grade of C.

TEXT *Elementary Differential Equations and Boundary Value Problems, 11th Edition.*
By William E. Boyce, Richard C. DiPrima,
and Douglas B. Meade , Wiley, 2017
(Homework on Webwork using the link on Canvas)

GRADING	Homework	20%
	Midterm	30%
	Final	50%

COURSE GOALS

First and second order differential equations, separation of variables, linear differential equations, systems of first order equations, nonlinear differential equations and stability. (Chapters 1-4, 6, 7,9 in the text book).

EXAMS

Three exams (in-class) will be given on the following days:

- January 29 (1st Midterm)
- February 24 (2nd Midterm, non-accumulative)
- March 17 (Final, accumulative)

I will drop your lowest score of the two midterms. [There will not be make-up exams for midterms.](#) Dropped exam scores will be used to compensate for exams missed because of illness, technology issues, or other mishaps beyond my control. Accommodations for students with disabilities will be made through the [Disabled Students Program](#) (DSP).

TA INFORMATION

This course has multiple discussion sections and a team of TAs. Each TA will post their office hour schedule, MathLab information, and any Zoom links on Canvas. Please attend the discussion section you are enrolled in, and feel free to contact your TA by email with any questions.

HOMEWORK

Links to online homework assignments using the Webwork platform will be posted on Gauchospace at least one week in advance of the due date. You are responsible for checking the due date. I will drop your lowest homework score. [Homework deadlines will not be extended.](#)

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

You should familiarize yourself with the [UCSB Student Conduct Code](#). It is expected that all students subscribe to the ideal of academic integrity, and are willing to bear individual responsibility for their work. Any submission that fulfills an academic requirement must represent a student's original work. Any act of academic dishonesty, such as cheating, plagiarism, furnishing false information, unauthorized collaboration, or misuse of course materials will subject a person to University disciplinary action as detailed in the [UCSB Office of Student Conduct](#).

In this course, I encourage you to discuss homework questions and course content with other members of the class and the teaching assistants during the office hours. However, it will help you to develop your critical reasoning skills if you also spend time working independently on the homework. During the online exams, you may use the course materials posted on Gauchospace and the course textbook. You may not use any other sources, and you may not communicate with anyone regarding the exam during the 24-hour exam period. All instances of academic misconduct will be reported to the [UCSB Office of Student Conduct](#).

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